community



A group of people who live, work, or play together.
A community can be made up of a large or small group of people.

symbol





A picture, object or shape that represents something else, like a Canada flag.
The Maple Leaf is a symbol of Canada.

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Social Studies

Kindergarten: Time and Place Unit

Parent letter

Dear Kindergarten Families,

Our class is beginning a new Social Studies unit focused on communities and the places within them. I am excited to help students explore what makes a community meaningful and unique.

Throughout the unit, students will learn that a variety of places can be part of a community, such as:

- playgrounds
- natural areas
- schools
- fire stations
- police stations
- town or city halls

They will also learn that places in a community can be recognized by distinctive features and symbols, such as signs, logos, colours, or shapes that help us understand what a place is and what it is used for.

By the end of the unit, students will work toward the following goals:

- Recognize familiar places in the local community
- Share places that have personal, family, or group meaning

To support this learning, I encourage you to talk with your child at home about:

- places in your neighborhood or local community
- communities your family belongs to (school, sports teams, cultural groups, etc.)
- places that are important to your child or your family, and why they matter

These conversations help children connect their own experiences to what we are learning in class.

Thank you for your support and partnership. If you have any questions, please feel free to reach out.

[Your Name]
[Your Grade/Class Name]
[School Name]

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See Think Wonder



What do you see?



What do you think is going on?



What does it make you wonder?

purpose

This routine encourages students to make careful observations and thoughtful interpretations. I helps stimulate curiosity and sets the stage for inquiry.

Introducing & Exploring Ideas

PURPOSE

What kind of thinking does this routine encourage?

This routine emphasises the importance of observation as the basis for thinking and interpretation that follows the close looking of an image, object, video, excerpt of text, painting, photo etc. The stimulus should be evocative and engaging.

APPLICATION

When and where can it be used?

Use this routine:

- ❑ When you want students to think carefully about why something looks the way it does or is the way it is.
- ❑ Use at the beginning of a new unit to motivate student interest.
- ❑ Consider using with an interesting object near the end of a unit to encourage students to further apply their new knowledge and ideas

ASSESSMENT

How can I use this routine as an assessment?

- ❑ See responses → look for improvement in ability to notice details that take them deeper in the image/ object rather than getting stuck on immediate surface features.
- ❑ Think responses → pay attention to the kind of supports students are able to provide for their interpretations in response to the ***What makes you say that?*** prompt. Are they drawing on evidence to create coherent links?
- ❑ Wonder responses → look for questions that are more adventurous and broad rather than limited to those requiring specific factual responses.

Adapted by Alice Vigors 2017

LAUNCH

What are the steps needed for starting and using this routine?

1. ***Set up*** → Present the chosen image in a way that allows students to see as much detail as possible. Allow sufficient silent time for close observation, 2 or 3 minutes, before any talk or discussion.
2. ***See*** → Ask learners to state what they noticed. Emphasise we are not looking for interpretations at this stage, only what they observe. Useful prompt: *an observation is something you could actually put your fingers on within the image/object.*
3. ***Think*** → Ask learners what they think is going on in the image/ object. This general, interpretive question may be modified to suit what is being viewed. The goal here is to build up layers of tentative interpretation rather than merely naming the subject matter. Push for alternatives and additions → *What else is going on here? What do you see that makes you say that?* This encourages learners to provide supporting evidence.
4. ***Wonder*** → Ask learners what they are now wondering about based on what they have seen and have been thinking. Initially students may find it hard to separate "thinking" from "wondering". Using *'I wonder...'* can be useful to begin.
5. ***Share the thinking*** → Students generally share their thinking at each step along the way before moving on. This allows the class to build on the group's thinking at the previous stage and often results in richer discussions. It can be useful to document the thinking at each stage as it happens, although this is not always necessary.

1.3 Time and Place Conversation and Observation Checklist

Kindergarten – Time and Place

L.O. 1 – Children examine places in communities.

√ Understands the concept
< Understands the concept with help
* Requires more observation
X Does not understand the concept

Student Name	Recognize familiar places in the local community.			Share places that have personal, family, or group meaning.		
	Phase 1:Symbols and Places in the Community	Phase 2: Where would you go?	Phase 2: Community Centers	Phase 2: Community Centers	Phase 3: My School Community	Phase 4: Classroom Community Map

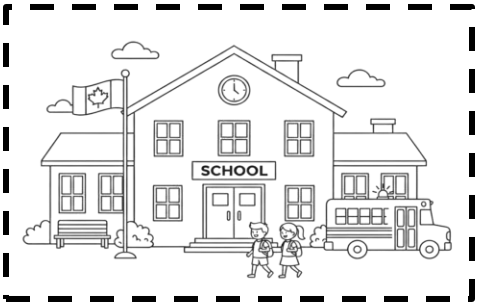
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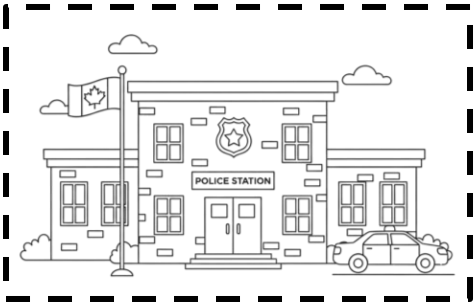
2.0 Where do we go?

Name_____

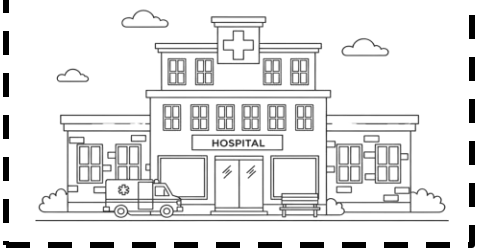
Cut out the pictures. Read the description of the community places. Match and glue each picture to where it belongs. Highlight two symbols or distinct features on each picture.

A place to read and get books to borrow.	A place to run and play outside.	A place to learn and be with friends.
A place that makes sure everyone stays safe.	A place that helps people who are sick or injured.	A place to buy food and other things.

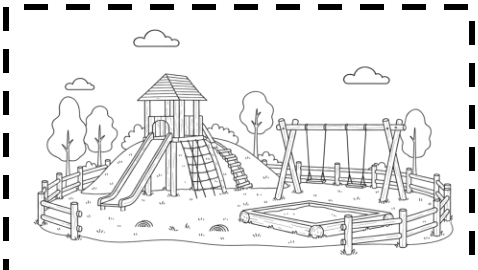












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2.0 Where do we go?

Name ANSWER KEY

Cut out the pictures. Read the description of the community places. Match and glue each picture to where it belongs. Highlight two symbols or distinct features on each picture.

A place to read and get books to borrow.



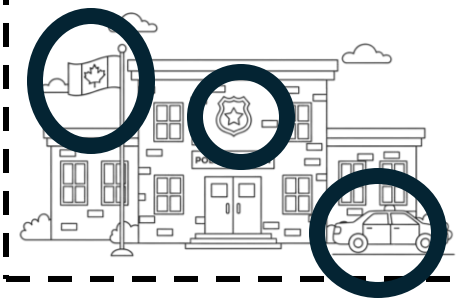
A place to run and play outside.



A place to learn and be with friends.



A place that makes sure everyone stays safe.



A place that helps people who are sick or injured.



A place to buy food and other things.



L.O. 1 – Children examine places in communities

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2.1 My Special Place

Kindergarten – Time and Place

Name_____

This place is in my community:



I visit this place with my family:



I visit this place with a different group:



I go to this place_____.

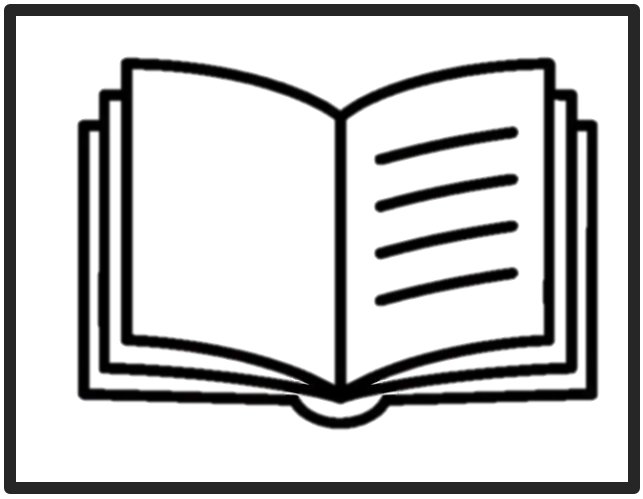
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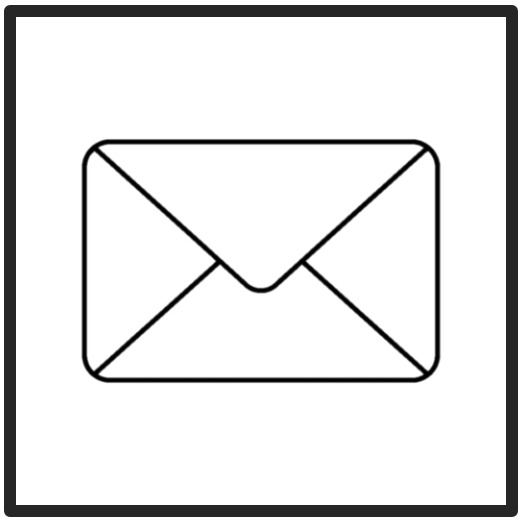
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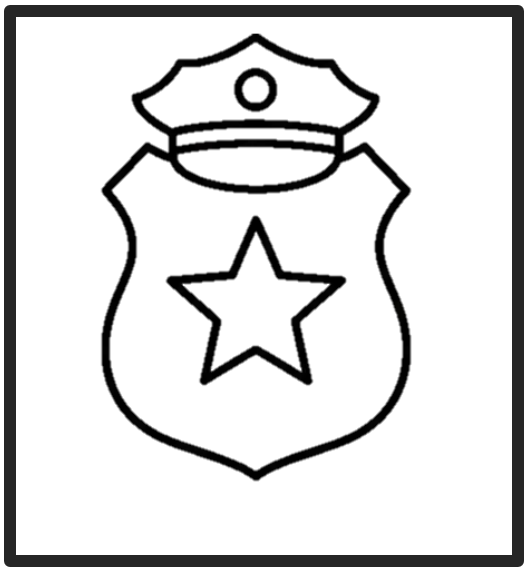
2.1 Block Building Symbol Cards

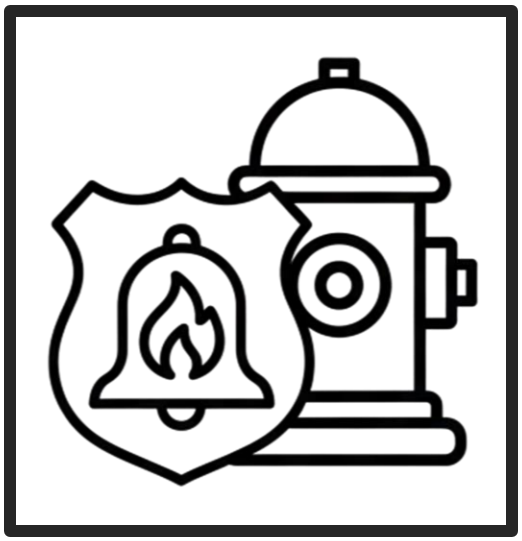
Kindergarten – Time and Place

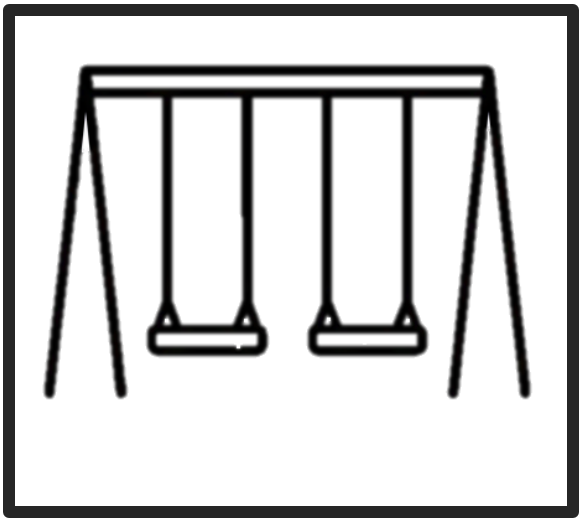












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2.1 Block Building Symbols

Kindergarten – Time and Place







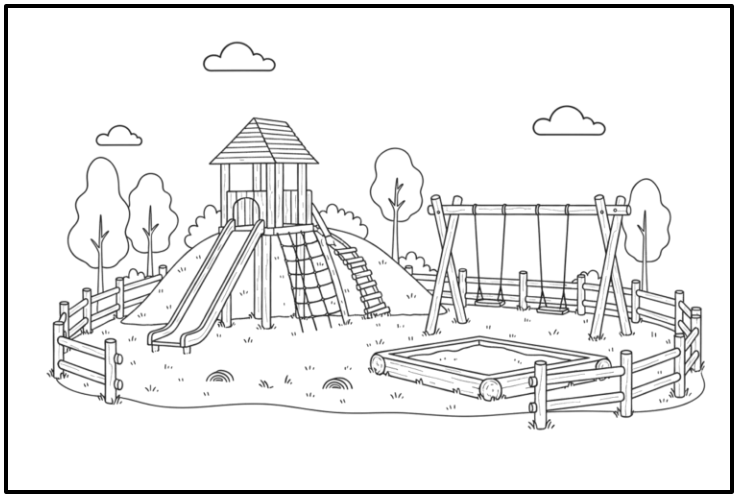


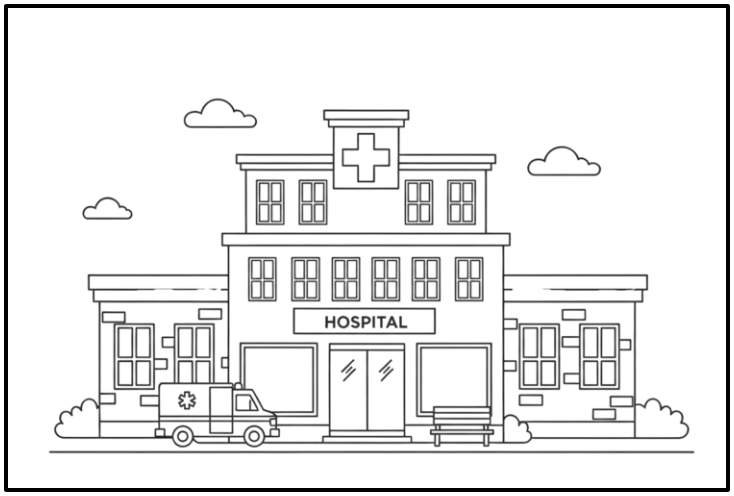
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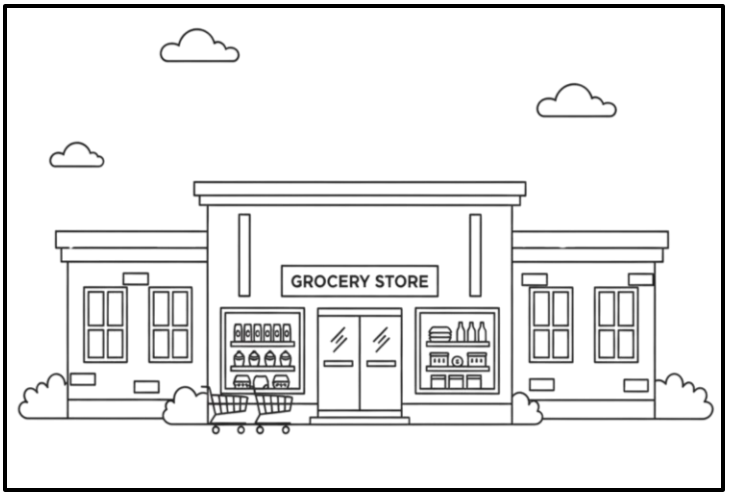
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2.1 Places and Symbols Matching

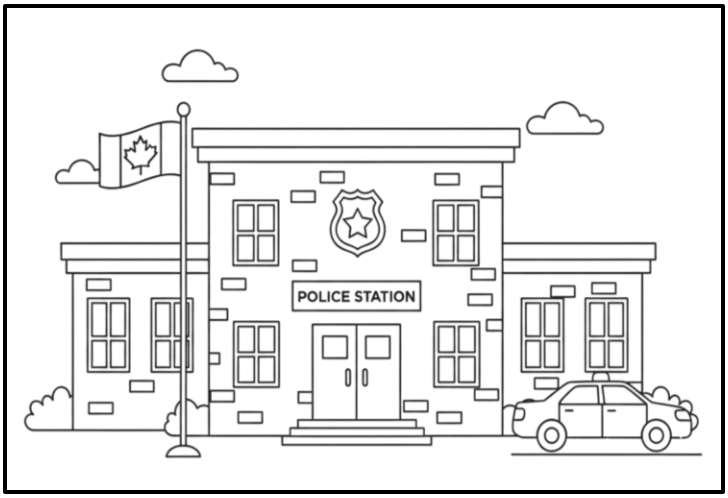
Kindergarten – Time and Place













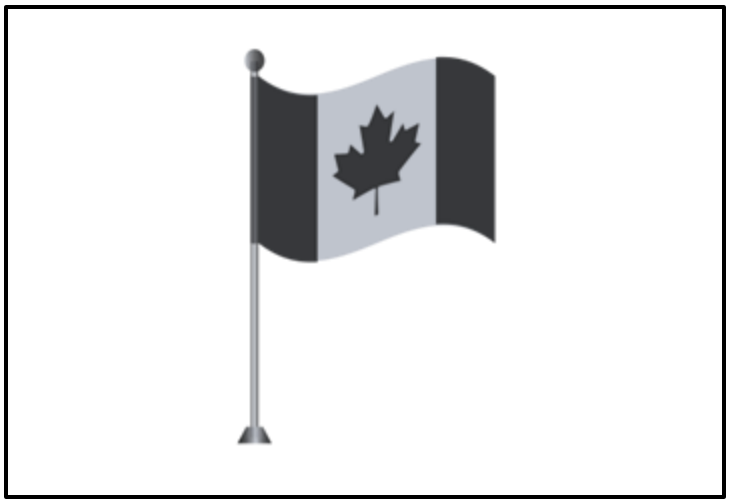
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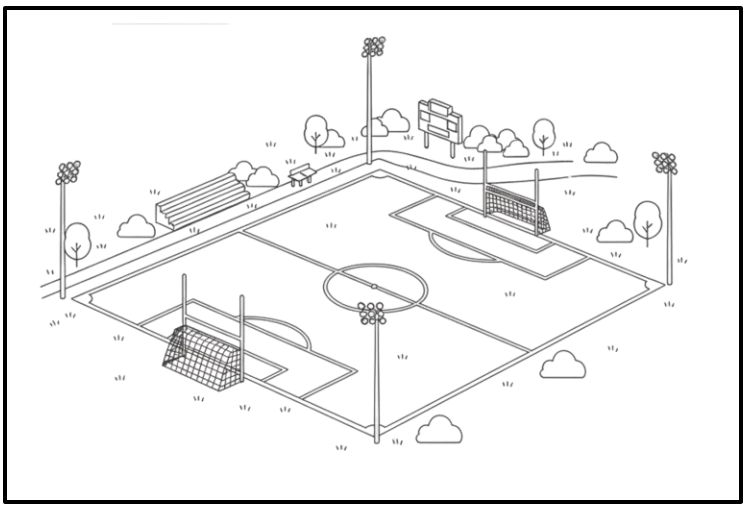
Kindergarten – Time and Place













L.O. 1 – Children examine places in communities.

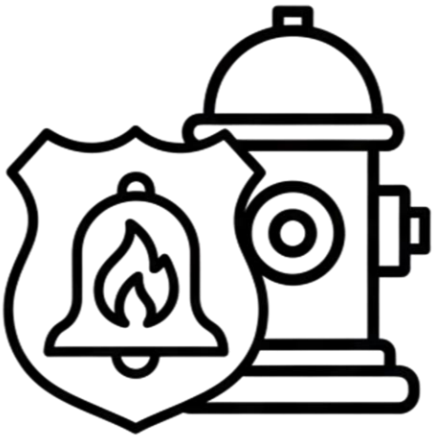
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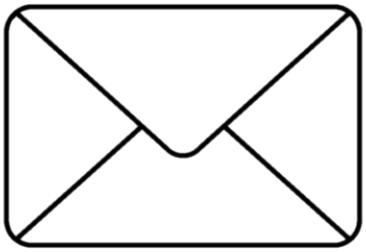
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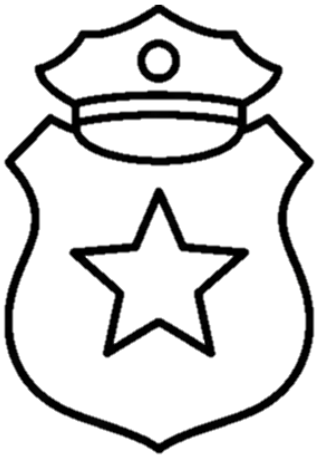
Kindergarten – Time and Place







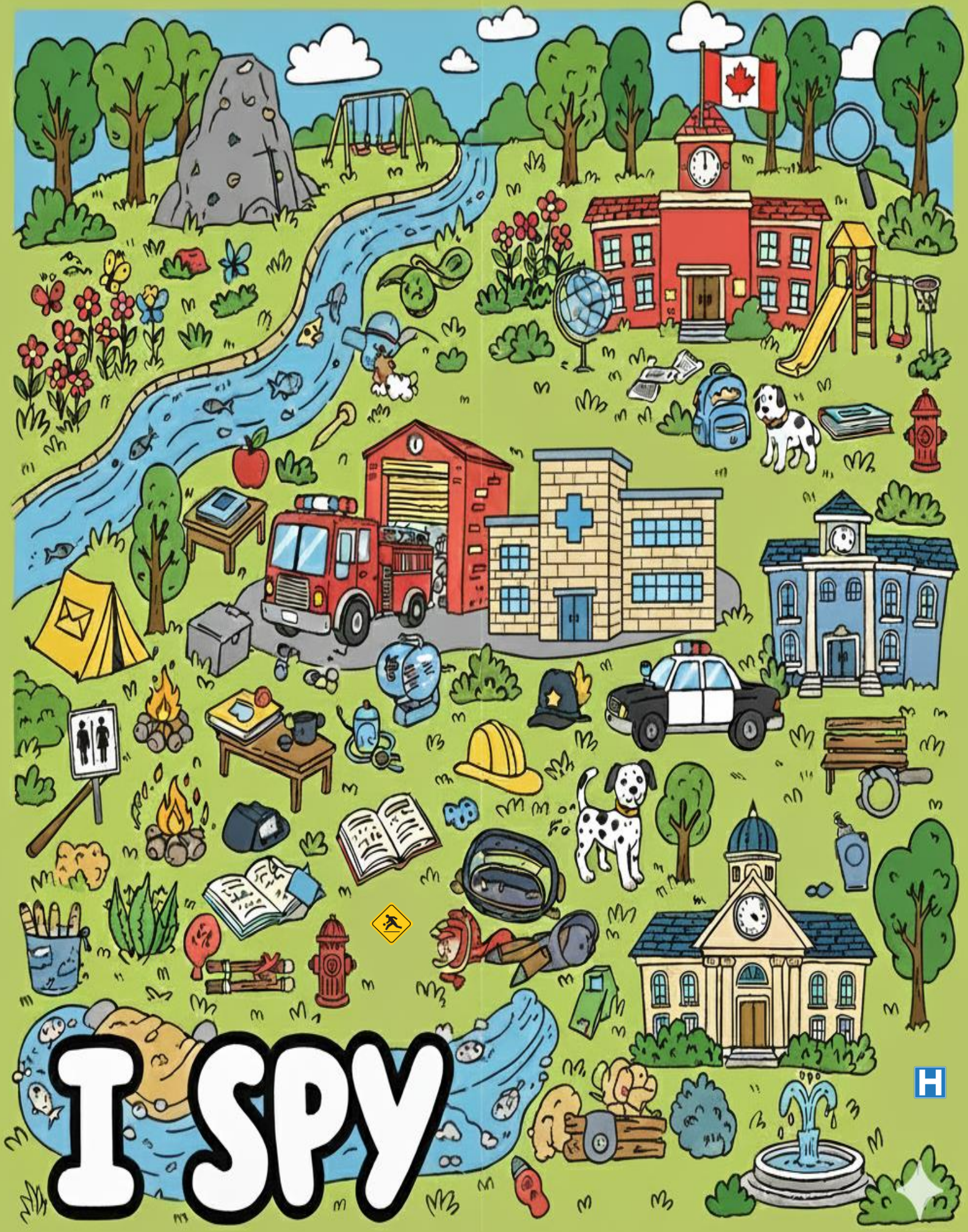






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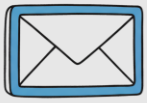
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I SPY

2.1 I Spy Symbols

Kindergarten

Name_____

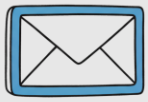
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Other Symbols I Found

2.1 I Spy Symbols

Kindergarten

Name_____

☐	
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☐	

Other Symbols I Found

3.0 My School Community

Kindergarten – Time and Place

Name: _____

A **symbol** in my school community.

People in my school community.

The name of my school is:

_____

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4.0 Classroom Community Map

Kindergarten – Time and Place



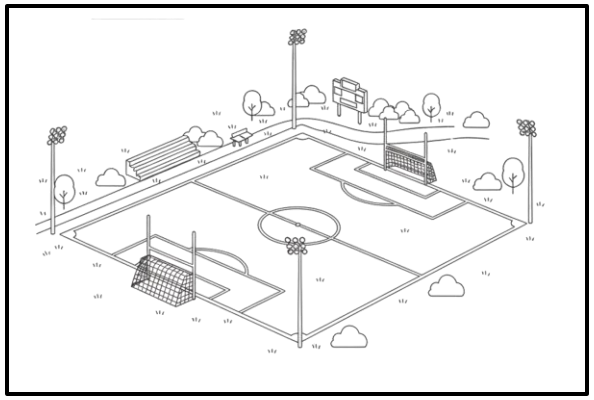


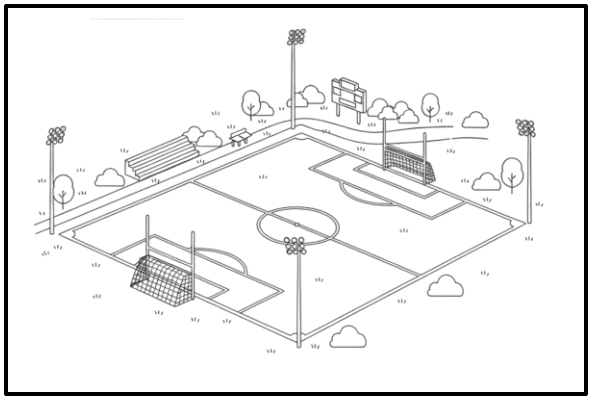


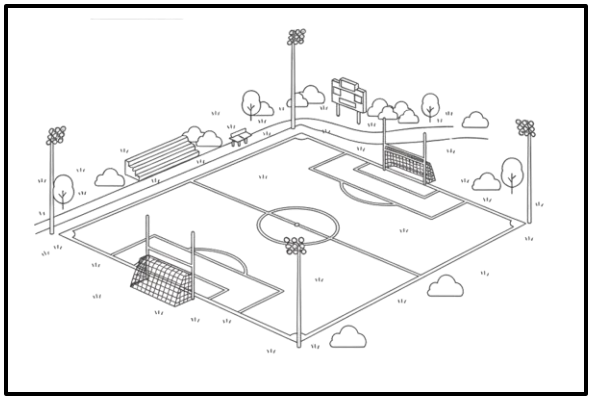






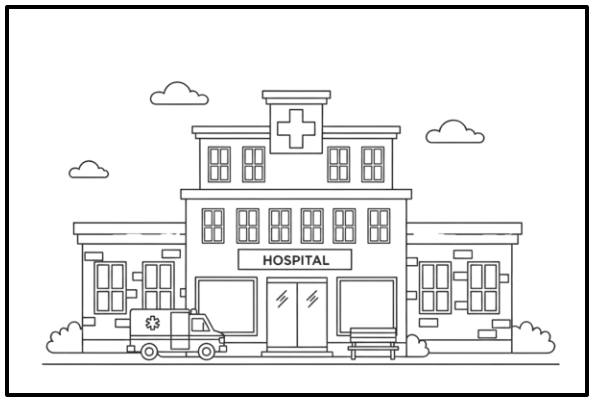


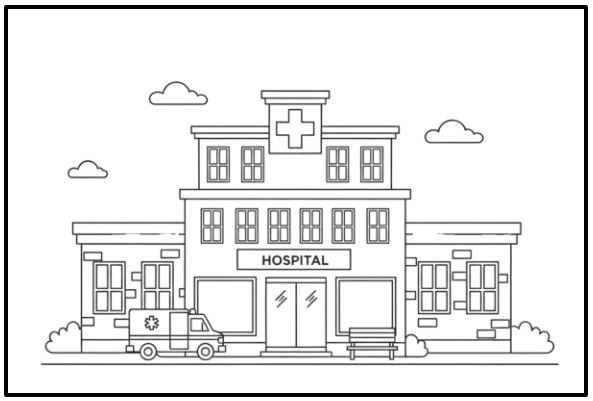


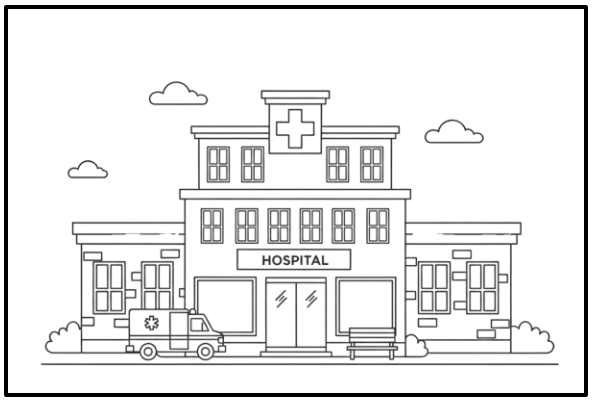


4.0 Classroom Community Map

Kindergarten – Time and Place



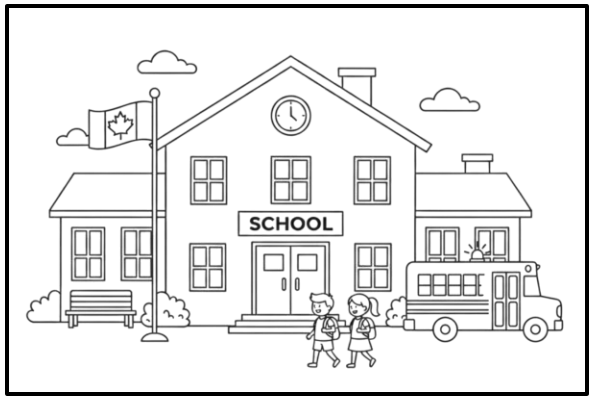


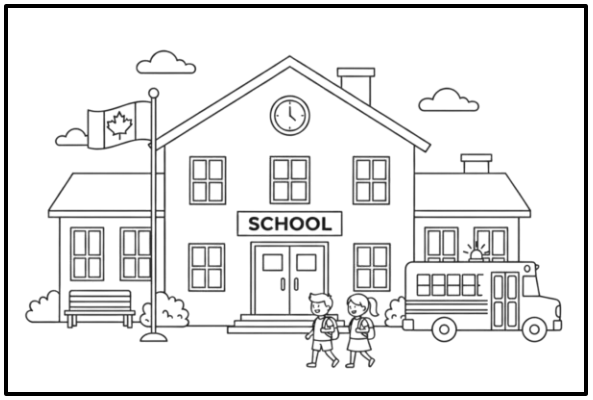


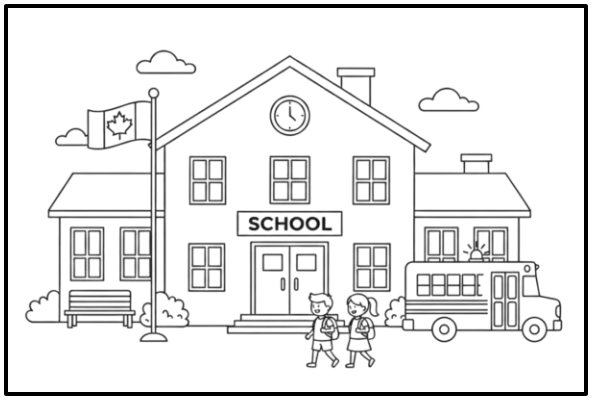






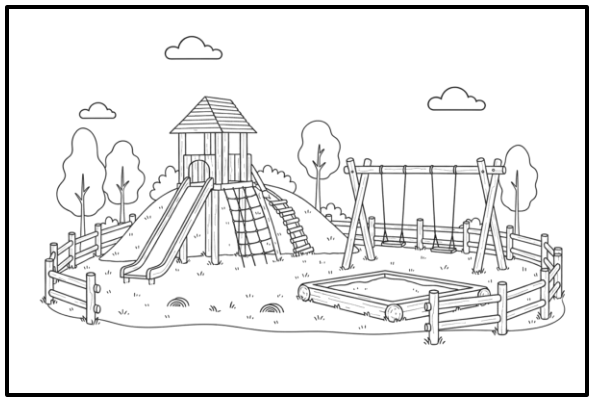


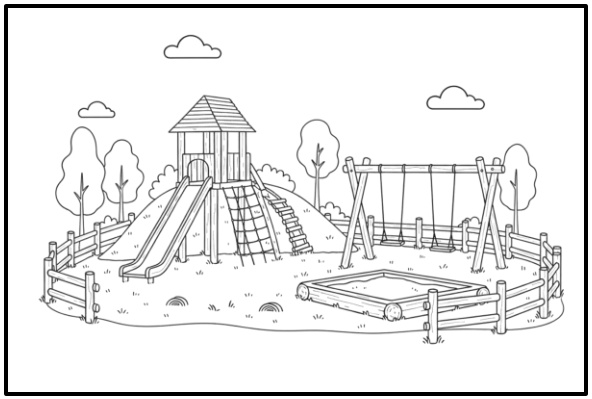


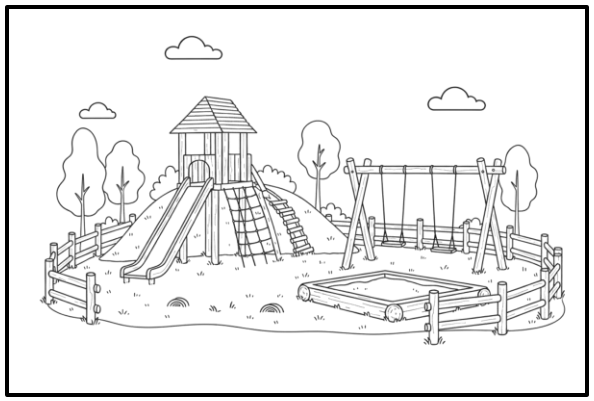


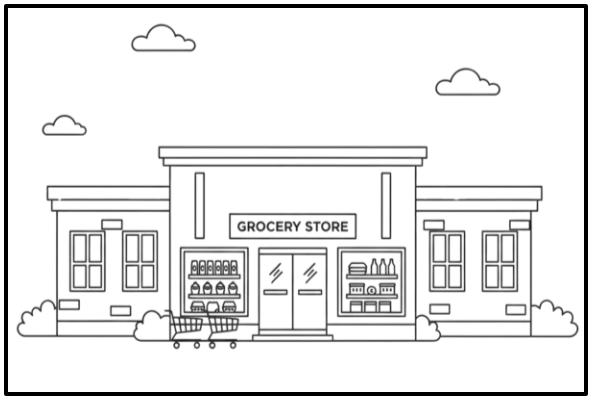
4.0 Classroom Community Map

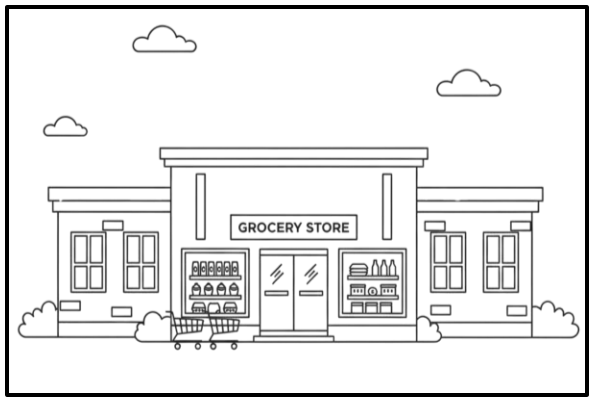
Kindergarten – Time and Place

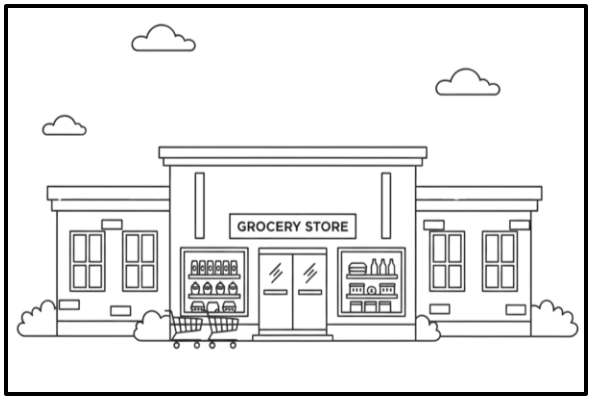


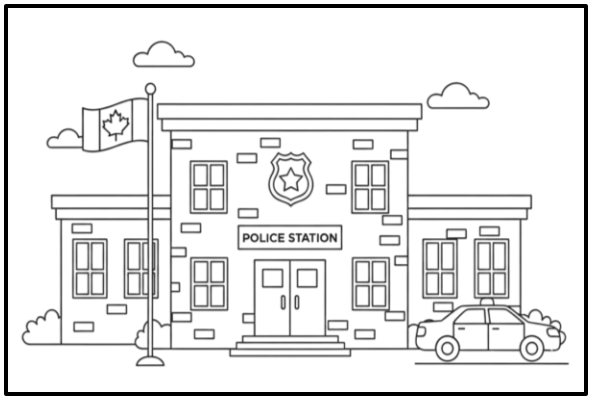


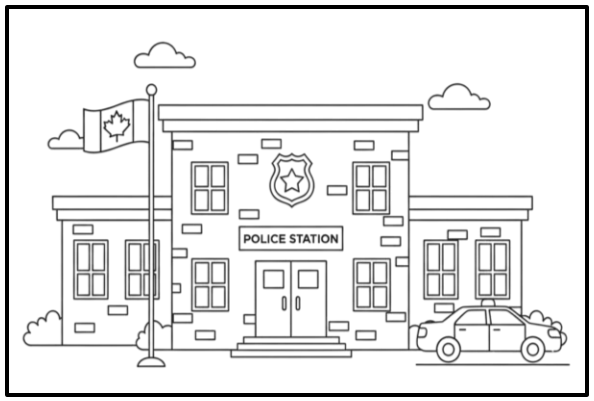


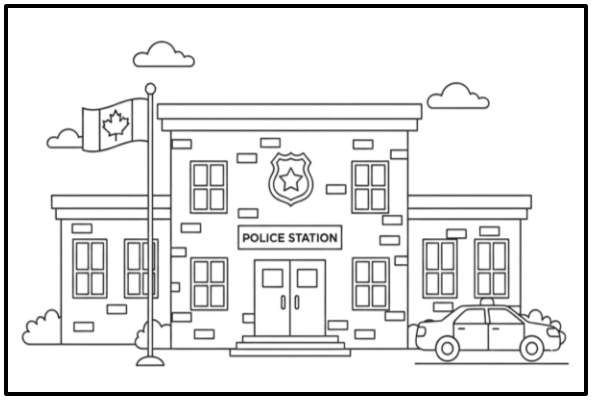






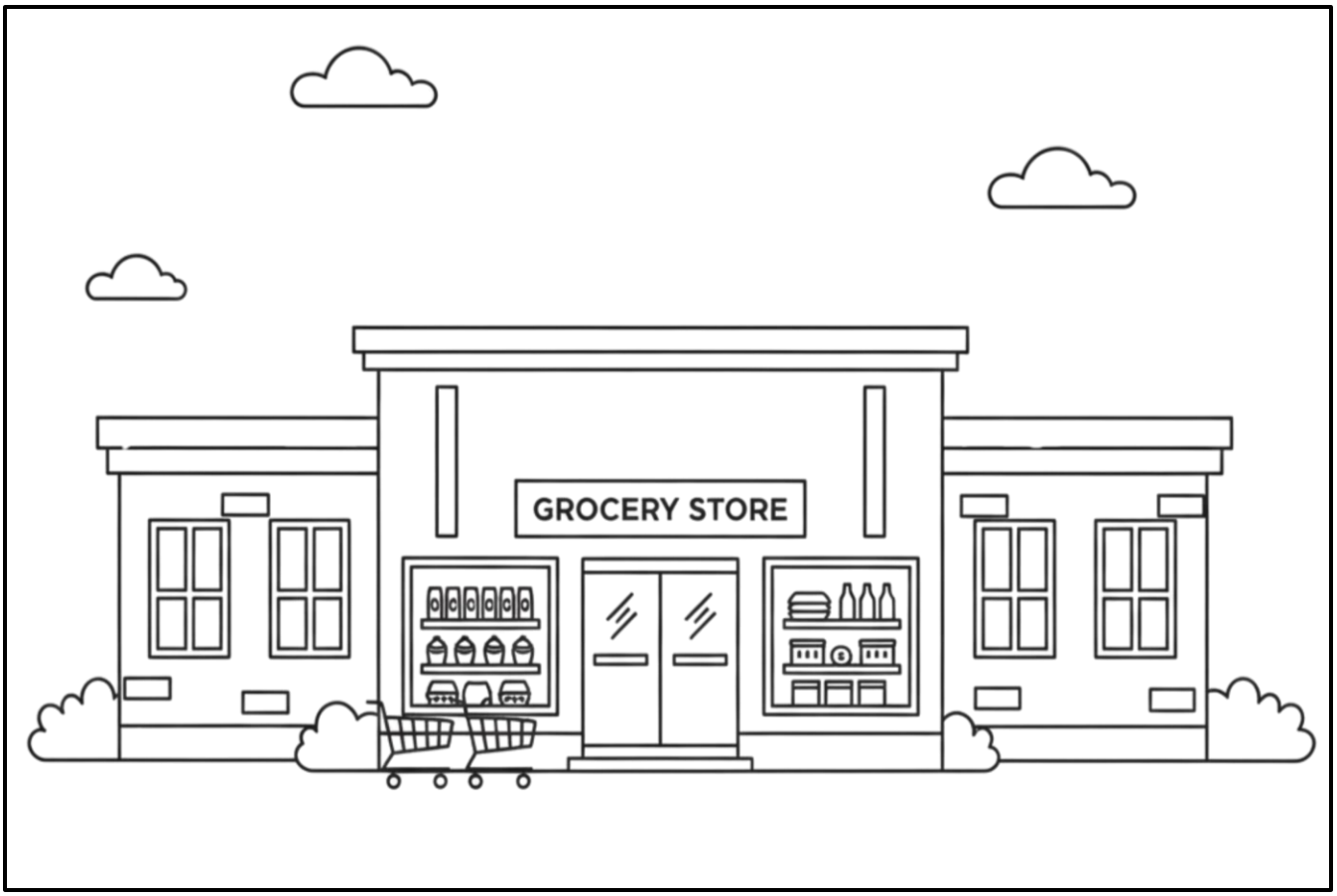






5.0 Community Picture Walk Images

Kindergarten – Time and Place



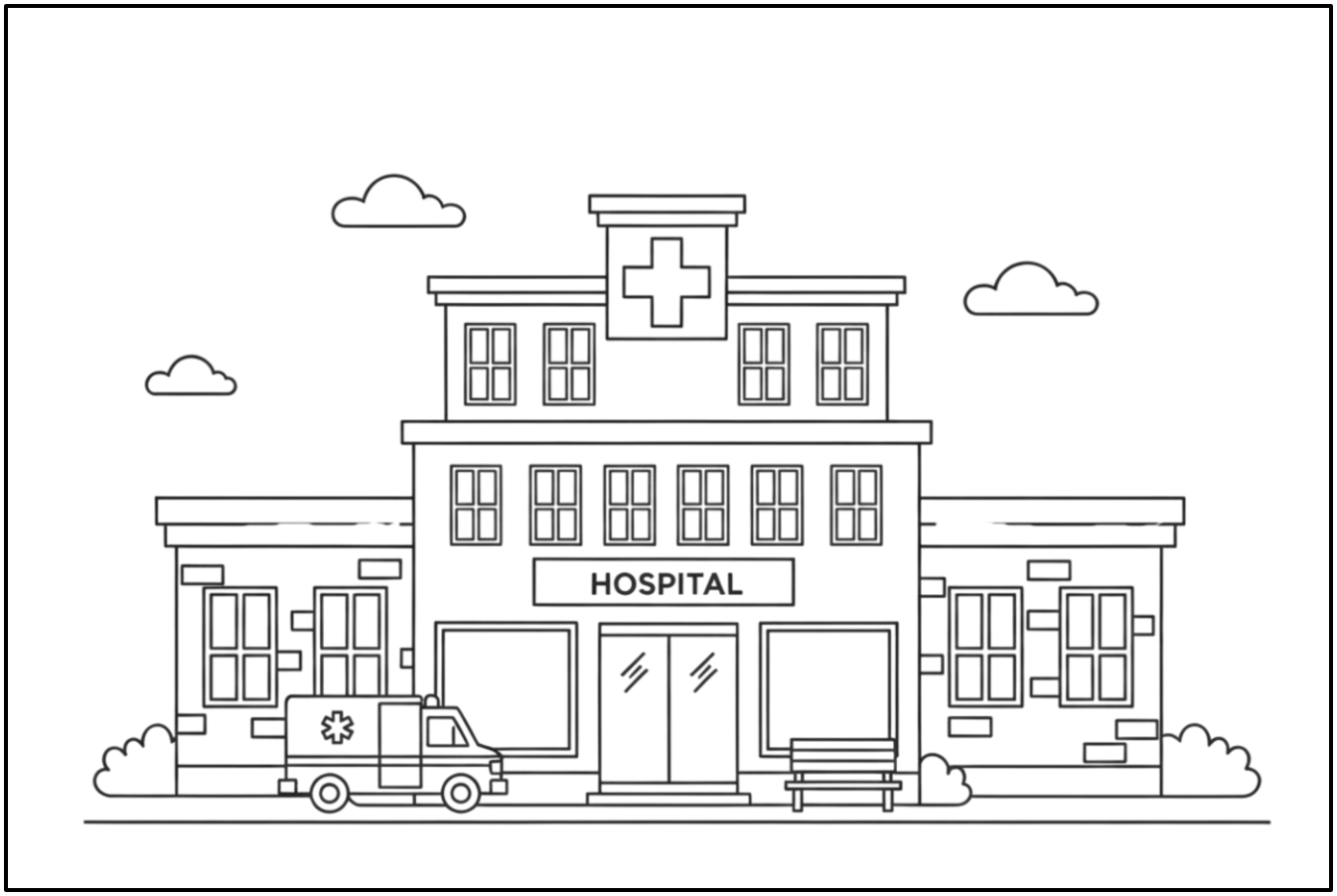


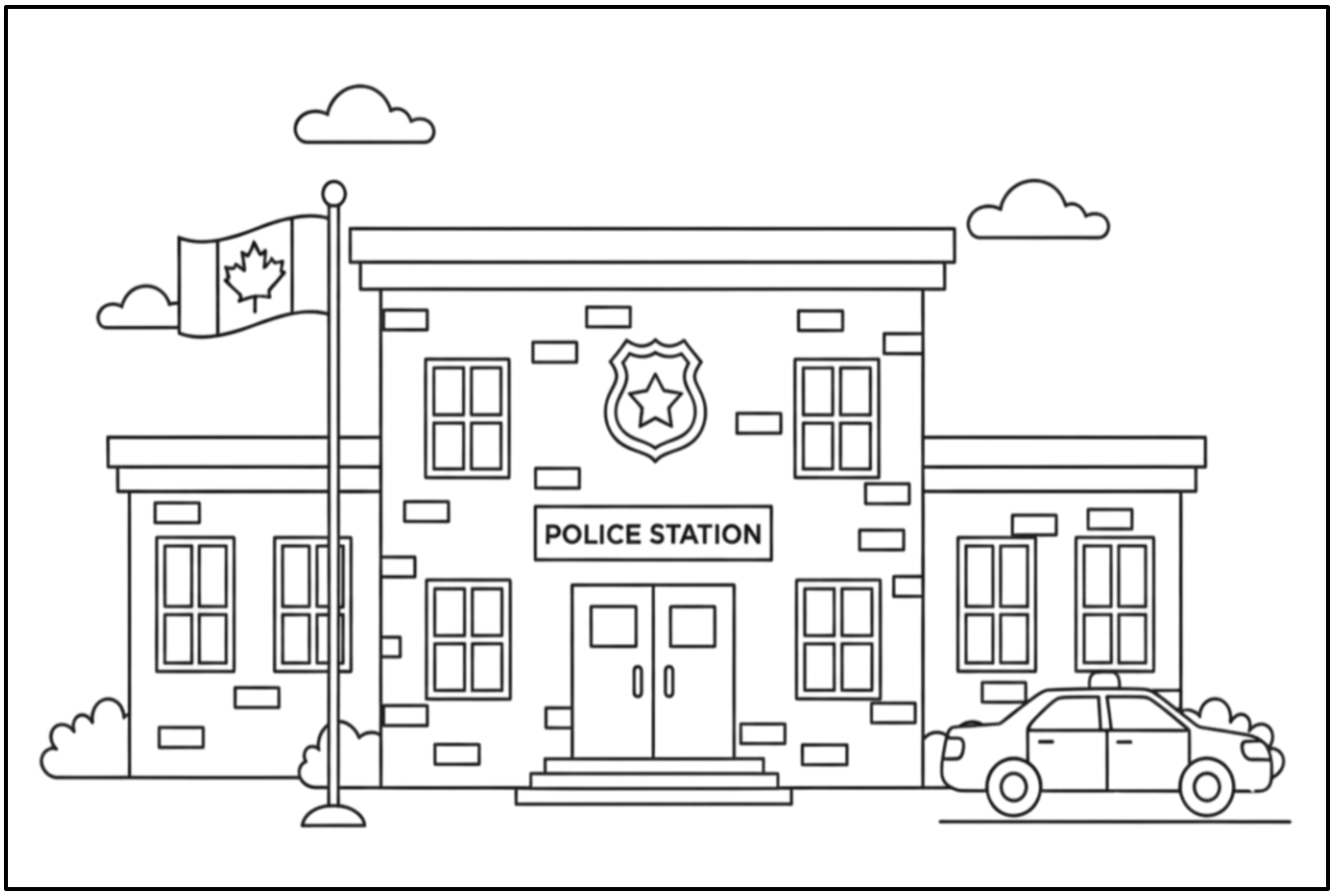
L.O. 1 – Children examine places in communities.

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5.0 Community Picture Walk Images

Kindergarten – Time and Place





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Kindergarten – Time and Place





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Kindergarten – Time and Place



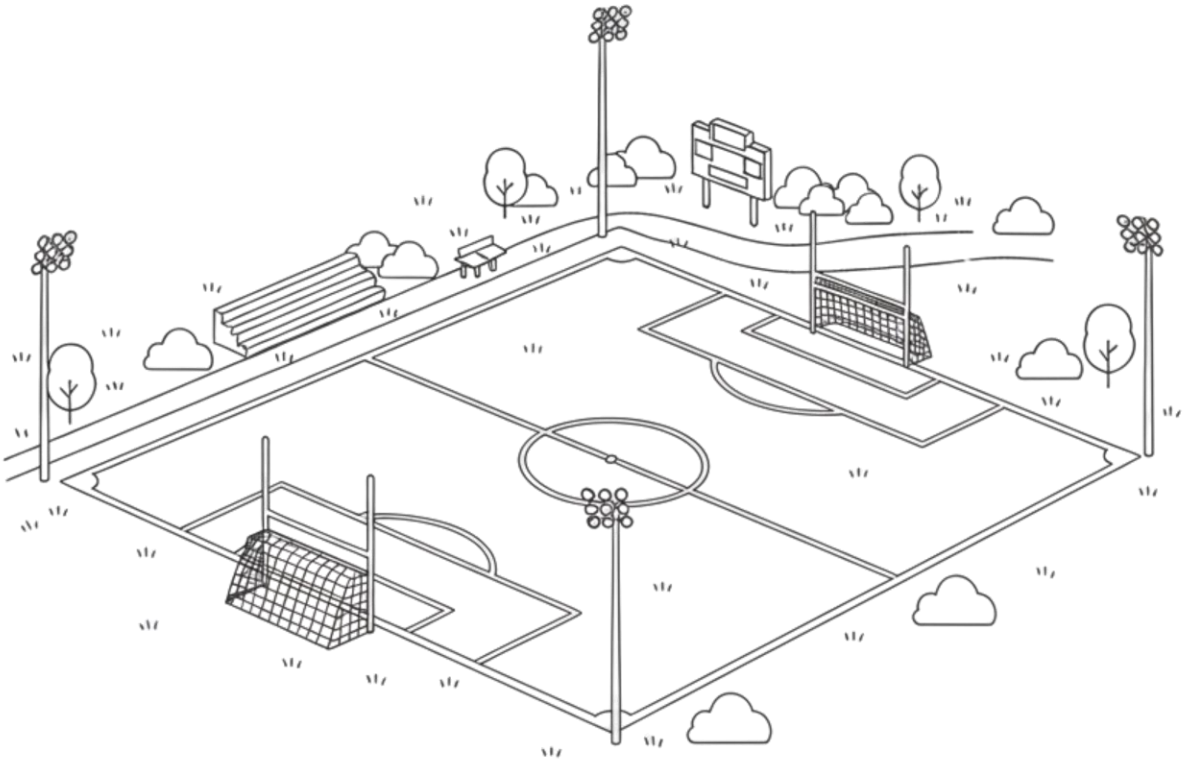


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5.1 5 Point Rubric – Community Picture Walk

Kindergarten – Time and Place

Name _____

Criteria	5	4	3	2	1
Recognizes Familiar Places and Symbols	Easily identifies all familiar community places. Clearly explains symbols, photos, or features that helped them recognize each place.	Identifies most familiar community places. Describes at least one symbol or feature that helped with recognition.	Identifies some familiar places with prompting. Points to or names a symbol with support.	Recognizes a place only after significant prompting or modeling. Has difficulty identifying symbols or features even with help.	Unable to identify places even with support. Does not recognize or use symbols or features to help.
Connection and Meaning (Who the Place is Important to)	Clearly explains who the place is important to (self, family, community helpers, groups). Shares many personal, family, or group connections.	Explains who the place is important to with minimal prompting. Shares at least one personal or family connection.	Gives a simple idea about who the place is important to with support. Shares a basic personal connection when prompted.	Needs repeated prompting to share who the place may be important to. Struggles to make personal or family connections.	Unable to explain who the place is important to even with support. Does not make personal or family connections.

L.O. 1 – Children examine places in communities.

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